CDL Prep Pricing Recheck: How We Compare

Pulled Wed Oct 28, 2026, about 9:15–9:20 AM PT. Sources: the public US App Store page for each app (its "In-App Purchases" list plus the "Contains Advertising" label), the iTunes lookup API (ratings, descriptions) and google-play-scraper (Play rating, installs, "Contains ads", IAP range, description). Raw data is in `cdl-2026-10-28/pricing/` (ios_pricing.json, gp_pricing.json, ios_*.html).

Our pricing (Sean approved): permit pack **$14.99** one-time, endorsements **$4.99 each** or **$19.99 all**, so **$34.98 for everything**. No ads, no subscription. We'll test $19.99 for the permit pack once reviews come in.

Limits on this data: - Apple lists IAP names and prices but not always the period. When the name doesn't say the period, I left it as "unlabeled." - Google Play shows only a price range. I didn't see the Play subscription periods. - No purchases or sign-ins were made, so I didn't see in-app paywalls, which can differ from these lists. - Estimates are marked (est.).

1. Current listings (iOS ranked by rating count; Play counterpart where one exists)

App (developer)	Store links	iOS rating (count)	Play rating (count), installs	Ads	Free tier	Subscriptions seen	One-time / lifetime	Endorsements in description
CDL Test Prep 2026 Class A B (Hanh Le)	iOS · Play: not found	4.90 (48,612)	n/a	iOS: yes	Free with ads	Pass Pro weekly $6.99, monthly $19.99	Remove Ads $5.99; 30-Day Pass $19.99; Lifetime $39.99	HazMat, Tanker, Doubles/Triples, Passenger, School Bus, Air Brakes, Combination; Spanish mentioned
CDL Exam Prep 2026 (Easy Pass)	iOS · Play	4.91 (27,615)	4.90 (72), 1,000+	iOS: yes. Play: no	iOS: basic tests free. Play: "100% free, no ads, no paywalls"	Weekly $9.99, monthly $19.99, quarterly $39.99, yearly $49.99 (iOS)	Lifetime $59.99 (iOS). Play shows no IAP	All 7
CDL Permit: Practice Test 2026 (Mapola)	iOS · Play: not found	4.75 (18,167)	n/a	No	Free trial mentioned	Monthly with trial "Special Offer" $9.99; unlabeled $24.99	Lifetime $99.99	HazMat, Tanker, Passenger, School Bus, Air Brakes, Combination
CDL Prep Test 2026 (Wei Zhang iOS / VZ INC APPS Play; I didn't confirm they're the same developer)	iOS · Play	4.88 (15,363)	4.92 (19,943), 500,000+	Yes	Fully free with ads	None (no IAP listed)	None	No endorsements named in the description
CDL Prep Practice Test Genie (DMV Genie / Elegant eLearning)	iOS · Play	4.78 (14,486)	4.79 (3,084), 100,000+	iOS: no. Play: yes	Limited free	Weekly $19.99; Premium 1-month $49.99; Class A 30-day $99.00; Class B 30-day $99.99; Non-ELDT	"Genie Premium" $14.99 (period unlabeled); All-in-one $39.99 / $49.99	All 7

App (developer)	Store links	iOS rating (count)	Play rating (count), installs	Ads	Free tier	Subscriptions seen	One-time / lifetime	Endorsements in description
						endorsements 30-day $49.99	(unlabeled); Lifetime $99.99. Play range $19.99–$219.99	
CDL Prep Test 2026 (Khai Vuong; on Play as Nam Nguyen Unisoft)	iOS · Play	4.72 (7,811)	3.28 (249), 100,000+	No	Free trial mentioned	"CDL Premium User" $9.99 / $19.99 / $48.99 (periods unlabeled)	"CDL Premium" $74.99 (probably lifetime, not confirmed). Play range $8.99–$74.99	Play: all 7. iOS: Hazardous, Passenger
CDL Prep (Jeffrey Diaz)	iOS · Play	4.68 (7,016)	4.57 (5,747), 1,000,000+	Yes	Fully free with ads	None	None	HazMat, Doubles/ Triples, Passenger, School Bus, Air Brakes, Combination (no Tanker named)
CDL Practice Test® 2026 (The PATG Group)	iOS · Play: not found	4.84 (6,123)	n/a	Yes	Practice bank, explanations and 50-state manuals are free. Only Exam Mode is paid	Monthly $17.99; yearly $99.00; "CDL Prep" $4.99 (unlabeled, likely weekly (est.))	None	All 7. Says it cites the FMCSA manual on every question
CDL Prep – Practice Test 2026 (Best Fun Games)	iOS · Play	4.64 (3,367)	4.62 (14,862), 100,000+	No	Limited free. Earlier today's page showed a 1-week free trial	Monthly $24.99; annual $59.99	Lifetime $59.99 / $74.99 / $89.99. Play range $24.99–$89.99	Hazardous, Passenger, Air Brakes, Combination
CDL Prep Practice Test – 2026 (Solvely / Aignite)	iOS · iOS only	4.83 (2,521)	n/a	No	Limited free	Weekly $11.99; monthly $15.99 / $19.99	1-Month Access $19.99 / $24.99; Lifetime $69.99	All 7; Spanish
CDL Practice Test Prep 2026 (BrainSoft / Genioworks)	iOS · Play	4.90 (10)	4.68 (507), 10,000+	Yes	Limited free	Weekly $2.99 / $9.99; yearly $39.99. Play range $2.49–$34.99	None seen	All 7

Other Play apps checked: - CDL Practice Written Test (DMV Written Test): 4.64 (4,650), 100,000+ installs, ads, IAP $10.99–$17.99. - CDL Test Prep (Vialsoft): 4.49 (2,617), 500,000+ installs, ads, IAP $4.99. - CristCDL.com: 4.52 (113), 10,000+ installs, ads, no IAP. - CDL Pass: 4.85 (253), ads, no IAP. - HLT Official CDL Iowa covers Iowa only: $4.99/mo or $19.99/yr per its description; Play range $6.99–$23.99.

2. What a student pays for full access

The 1-month and 3-month columns use the cheapest full-access path I could see. With every competitor, all endorsements come with the subscription, so "permit + all endorsements" costs the same as the study period. A paid period ends and features lock again; ours never expire.

App	1 month	3 months	Lifetime / own it	vs our $14.99 permit	vs our $34.98 everything
Ours	**$14.99** permit only / **$34.98** all	same (no expiry)	same	—	—
Hanh Le	$19.99 (Pro or 30-Day Pass); $5.99 removes ads only	$39.99 lifetime	$39.99	We're $5 cheaper	**We're $5.01 cheaper**
Easy Pass (iOS)	$19.99	$39.99 quarterly	$59.99	We're $5 cheaper	We're $5.01 cheaper over 3 months, $25 below its lifetime
Mapola	$9.99 "special offer" monthly; otherwise $24.99 (unlabeled)	$29.97 (est., 3× $9.99)	$99.99	**We cost more** if the $9.99 offer is real and repeats	**We cost more** over 3 months ($29.97); $65 cheaper than its lifetime
DMV Genie	$49.99 Premium month ($14.99 "Genie Premium" has no period shown)	$99.99 lifetime is cheapest	$99.99	We're $35 cheaper	We're $65 cheaper
Khai Vuong	$9.99–$19.99 (periods unlabeled)	likely $48.99 (est.)	$74.99 (likely)	Unclear	We're about $14–40 cheaper (est.)
PATG	$0 practice; $17.99 for Exam Mode	$53.97 (est., 3× monthly)	none; $99/yr	We cost more than free practice; $3 cheaper than Exam Mode	We're $19 cheaper over 3 months
Best Fun Games	$24.99	$59.99 (annual or lifetime)	$59.99	We're $10 cheaper	We're $25.01 cheaper
Solvely	$15.99	$47.97 (est., 3× $15.99)	$69.99	We're $1 cheaper	We're $13 cheaper over 3 months, $35 below its lifetime
BrainSoft	about $12.86 at $2.99/week (est.; may be an intro rate), or $42.96 at $9.99/week	$39.99 yearly	none	**Possibly we cost more** at the $2.99 rate	We're $5.01 cheaper
Jeffrey Diaz / Wei Zhang-VZ / CristCDL / CDL Pass	$0 with ads	$0	$0	**We cost more**	**We cost more**
Easy Pass (Play)	$0, no ads, per its description	$0	$0	**We cost more**	**We cost more**

3. Verdict

- **Cheaper than nearly every paid, ad-free full-access option.** At $14.99 the permit pack undercuts every standard 1-month price I could confirm ($15.99–$49.99). At $34.98 the full bundle is below every lifetime price seen ($39.99–$99.99) and below most 3-month costs ($39.99–$99.99).
- **Not much cheaper than the strongest rival.** Hanh Le has the most ratings in the category (48.6k at 4.9). It's free with ads, offers a $5.99 one-time ad removal, and has a $39.99 lifetime. That's only $5 above our full bundle and it includes every endorsement plus an AI tutor. Price alone won't beat it.
- **Where we cost more:**
- The free ad-supported apps: Jeffrey Diaz (1M+ Play installs), VZ (19.9k Play ratings at 4.92), CristCDL and CDL Pass.
- PATG's free practice bank.

- Easy Pass on Play, which is free with no ads (but small: 72 ratings).
- Possibly Mapola's $9.99 monthly offer and BrainSoft's $2.99 weekly.
- Hanh Le's $5.99 remove-ads for someone who only wants ad-free basic practice.
- **"No subscription" is our clearest difference.** Nine of the 11 iOS apps sell auto-renewing plans, and several have weekly plans ($2.99–$19.99/week) or 30-day passes that cost $49.99–$99.99 (DMV Genie). One fair price with no expiry still sets us apart.
- **"No ads" is only a partial difference.** Mapola, DMV Genie (iOS), Best Fun Games, Khai Vuong and Solvely are already ad-free (they sell subscriptions instead). The free apps are the ones with ads.
- **"Accuracy" is already being claimed.** PATG says every question cites the FMCSA manual and calls itself "not a clone." Hanh Le has a "Report mistake" button and says its bank is updated for the 2026 handbook. To make accuracy believable we need more than the claim: cite the state manual section on every question, show a "last verified" date, and lead with HazMat and state-specific depth (from the Task 1 research).
- **Recommendation:** keep the $14.99 / $4.99 / $19.99 launch pricing. Market it as "$34.98 once, everything, forever. No ads, no auto-renew" next to the $19.99/month and $39.99–$99.99 lifetime norms.
- Offer some free practice (for example one free test per section). Most of the top apps have a free tier and the very top ones are fully free, so a hard paywall would lose the install comparison.
- Testing $19.99 later is reasonable. The full bundle would then be $39.98, roughly level with Hanh Le's lifetime and still under Easy Pass, Solvely, Best Fun Games, DMV Genie and Mapola.